

Ideation Phase Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Template

Date	
Team ID	
Project Name	ServiceNow-Based Employee Laptop Request Application
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Template:

Brainstorming provides a free and open environment that encourages everyone within a team to participate in the creative thinking process that leads to problem solving. Prioritizing volume over value, out-of-the-box ideas are welcome and built upon, and all participants are encouraged to collaborate, helping each other develop a rich amount of creative solutions.

Use this template in your own brainstorming sessions so your team can unleash their imagination and start shaping concepts even if you're not sitting in the same room.

Reference: <https://www.mural.co/templates/brainstorm-and-idea-prioritization>

Step-1: Team Gathering, Collaboration and Select the Problem Statement

Problem Statement: “How might we simplify and speed up the process for employees to request, get approval for, and receive a laptop?” This became the focus problem statement for the brainstorming session, derived from PS-1 and PS-2.

Step-2: Brainstorm, Idea Listing and Grouping

The team listed possible solutions to address the problem statement. Six candidate ideas were generated and grouped below:

Brainstorm: Candidate Solutions for Laptop Request Process

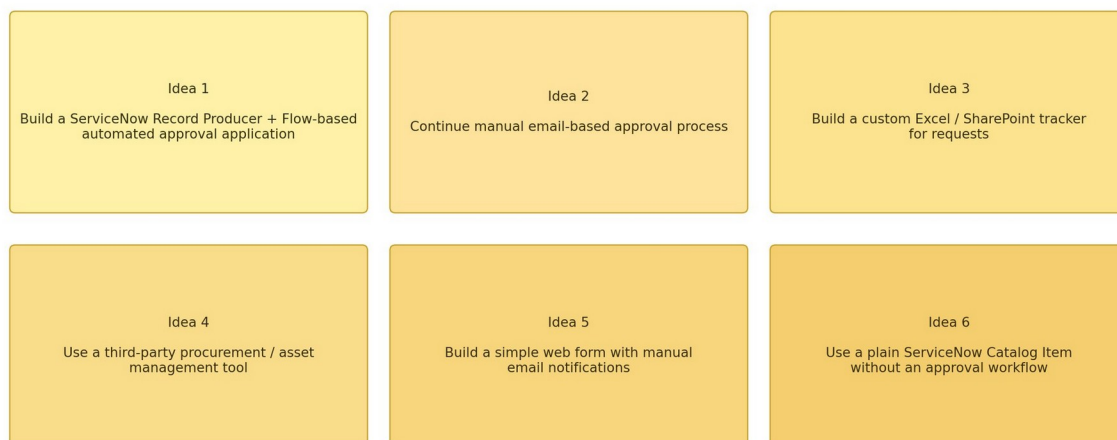


Figure 1.1 — Brainstorm: Candidate Solutions for Laptop Request Process

Step-3: Idea Prioritization

Each idea was plotted on an Importance vs Feasibility grid so the team could agree on what to build. The ServiceNow Record Producer + Flow-based automated approval application scored highest on both importance and feasibility, and was selected as the solution to build.

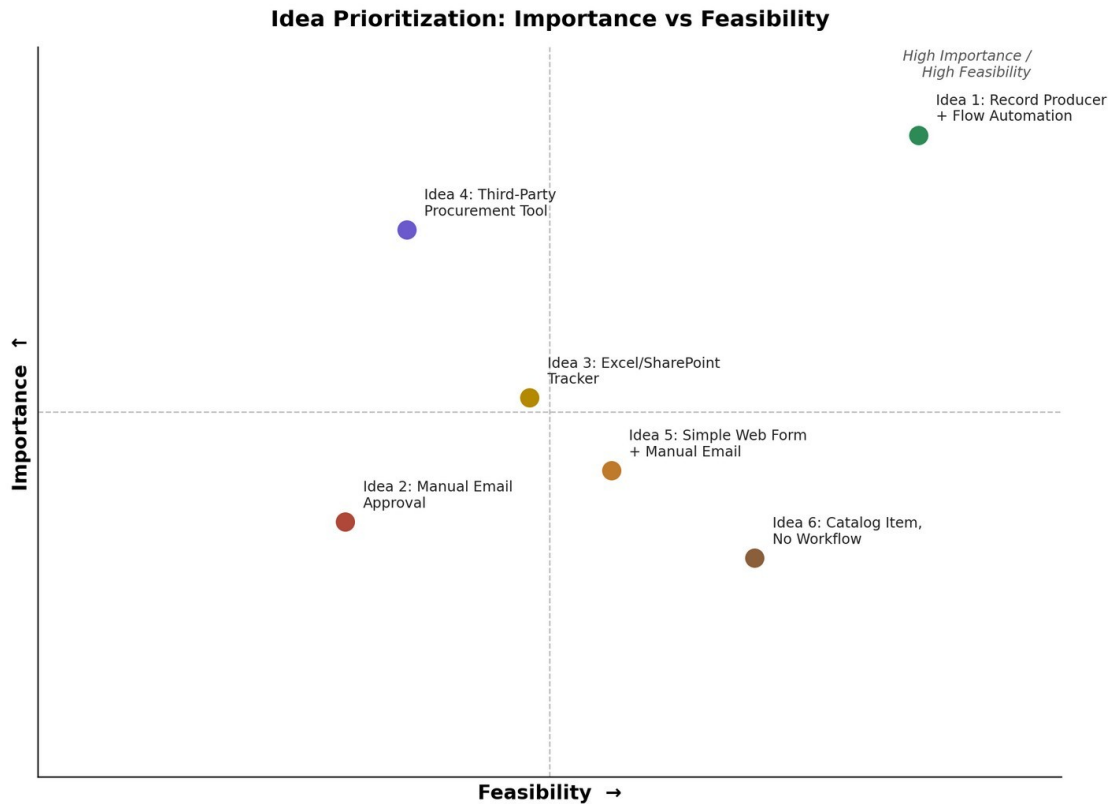


Figure 1.2 — Idea Prioritization: Importance vs Feasibility

Idea Comparison: Pros & Cons

Before finalizing the solution, the team weighed the trade-offs of each candidate idea:

Idea	Pros	Cons
1. Record Producer + Flow (Selected)	Automated, native to ServiceNow, filtered approvals, notifications built-in	Requires initial setup effort (table design, flow logic)
2. Manual Email Approval	No development needed, familiar to everyone	Slow, error-prone, no audit trail or tracking
3. Excel / SharePoint Tracker	Easy to set up, low cost	Manual updates, no real-time status, easy to lose sync
4. Third-Party Procurement Tool	Feature-rich, purpose-built for asset requests	Extra licensing cost, integration effort, low feasibility
5. Simple Web Form + Manual Email	Quick to build, centralizes request intake	Approval step still manual; no workflow automation
6. Catalog Item without Workflow	Fast to configure	No approval control; requests could be fulfilled without manager sign-off

Step-4: Final Decision & Rationale

The team selected Idea 1 — a ServiceNow Record Producer paired with a Flow-based Approval process — as the solution for the Employee Laptop Request Application. This idea scored highest on both importance and feasibility because:

- It uses native ServiceNow capabilities (Record Producer, Flow Designer, Approvals) already available on the platform, requiring no external tools or licensing.
- It automatically routes each request to the correct manager for approval, removing manual email follow-ups.
- It supports role-based, filtered views (e.g., 'My Approvals') so managers only see relevant records.
- It can trigger automatic notifications to the employee and IT admin once a request is approved or rejected.

This decision carried forward into Phase 2 (Requirement Analysis & Planning), where the table structure, relationships, roles, and flow logic were designed in detail.